

UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

TUESDAY, 22 SEPTEMBER 2026

3 must-know stories, 11 Prelims facts, 15 editorials and 5 explainers, picked from 66 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

[Open this brief online: summaries, Ask Intel and practice MCQs](#)

MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2

MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court rejects Centre's plea on private complaints in Companies Act fraud cases

The Supreme Court rejected the Centre's plea regarding private complaints in fraud cases. Special courts cannot take cognisance of such complaints filed under the Companies Act. This ruling ensures further scrutiny before fraud allegations are considered. The court allowed the Centre to authorize officers to file complaints in these matters. The decision stemmed from a case involving former directors of Shreemukh Namitha Homes.

Who: Supreme Court · **Prelims:** The court allowed the Centre to authorize officers to file complaints in these matters.; The decision stemmed from a case involving former directors of Shreemukh Namitha Homes.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

[Economic Times: read the source](#)

Economy

GS2 GS3

MAKE NOTES

Reserve Bank of India (All India Financial Institutions - Classification, Valuation, and Operation of Investment Portfolio) Amendment Directions, 2026

RBI/2026-27/268 DOR.MRG.REC.No.232/00-00-017/2026-27 September 22, 2026 Reserve Bank of India (All India Financial Institutions - Classification, Valuation, and Operation of Investment Portfolio) Amendment Directions, 2026 Please refer to Chapter – VI of Reserve Bank of India (All India Financial Institutions - Classification, Valuation, and Operation of Investment Portfolio) Directions, 2025, dated November 28, 2025, on market value of investments. In order to ensure clarity and uniform practices in the valuation of units of Infrastructure Investment Trust (InvIT) and Real Estate Investment Trusts (REIT), there is a need to amend the extant instructions. Accordingly, in exercise of the powers conferred...

Who: RBI

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Economy, Polity & Constitution, Infrastructure & Energy · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

[RBI: read the source](#) · also reported by [Economic Times](#)

Environment & Ecology

GS3

MAKE NOTES

Survey discovers six new species from Periyar Tiger Reserve in Keralam

Four-day faunal survey records six species previously undocumented in the reserve, including one bird, one butterfly, and four odonate species...

Where: Keralam

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology · Prelims angle: Report/Index, Species, Place in news

[The Hindu: read the source](#)

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

ECONOMY

QUICK READ

India's new GDP series: GST, corporate data drive new methodology

India's revamped GDP calculation incorporates extensive corporate filings and GST data, as revealed by the statistics ministry. This update emphasizes the integration of company-level information for a more precise estimation of private corporate sector activities. Furthermore, an innovative methodology leverages corporate filings and LLP records to enhance industry classification, while surveys are used for direct assessments of the household and unincorporated sectors.

[Economic Times: source](#)

DEFENCE

EXERCISE

QUICK READ

US stealth fighter F-35 among global air assets to headline Exercise Tarang Shakti in Jodhpur

The Indian Air Force announced that seven foreign nations—including the US, France, Germany, Australia, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, and the UAE—will participate in the second edition of Exercise Tarang Shakti at Jodhpur Air Force Station from September 26 to October 12.

[Economic Times: source](#)

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

AGREEMENT/MOU

PLACE IN NEWS

QUICK READ

Trump signs Arctic security pact with Denmark, Greenland after months of tensions

The United States, Denmark and Greenland have signed a security pact. This agreement expands American military access to the strategically vital Arctic island. It aims to strengthen security in the Arctic and North Atlantic regions. The deal formally retains Danish sovereignty over Greenland while increasing US involvement. This pact follows months of US pressure for greater control of the territory.

[Economic Times: source](#)

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY

SPECIES

PLACE IN NEWS

QUICK READ

New checklist by Keralam research team records 3,261 flowering plant species in Agasthyamalai Biosphere Reserve

Compilation by team from Jawaharlal Nehru Tropical Botanic Garden and Research Institute seeks to reaffirm global significance of Western Ghats as a biodiversity hotspot and need for focused, region-specific strategies for protecting it...

[The Hindu: source](#)

GOVERNANCE & POLICY

SCHEME

QUICK READ

Special swaps rake in \$143.5 billion in forex inflows: FCNR(B) scheme leads with \$133 billion

Banks mobilised \$132.9 billion through FCNR(B) deposits under the RBI's special forex swap window, taking total inflows, including ECBs and OFCBs, to \$143.5 billion by September 18. The inflows are more than five times those raised under a similar 2013 scheme, with banks raising a significant portion in the final 10 days.

[Economic Times: source](#)

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED

ACT/BILL/RULES

QUICK READ

Towards recognising women farmers

Maharashtra's passage of the Women Farmers' Empowerment Bill, granting women independent recognition as farmers irrespective of land ownership, brings into focus the structural bias against the female agricultural workforce, highlights the need for a database of women farmers and using it to ensure access to welfare schemes...

[The Hindu: source](#)

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

QUICK READ

Satellite images show China building new class of submarine, India's submarine plans compared

Fresh satellite imagery of a Chinese submarine under construction has highlighted developments in Beijing's nuclear-powered attack submarine designs, including a possible pumpjet propulsion system and X-shaped stern. At the same time, India is pursuing several submarine programmes to expand and modernise its underwater fleet. Recent submarine construction data also points to different fleet sizes and development timelines for China and India.

[Economic Times: source](#)

DISASTER MANAGEMENT

QUICK READ

El Niño brings drought and extreme rain together

Mandvi taluka in Kutch district, Gujarat, received around 177 mm of rain in just eight hours on September 15, causing widespread waterlogging and disrupting normal life. Until then, the district had faced a 70% rainfall deficit. The India Meteorological Department (IMD) said on September 15 that several parts of Gujarat, along with Madhya Pradesh and

[Mongabay India: source](#)

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY

REPORT/INDEX

QUICK READ

Chemists report ‘milder’ way to swap carbon for nitrogen atoms

Scientists have reported a reaction to replace carbon with nitrogen in types of molecules often encountered in medical research and industry without using harsh oxidants...

[The Hindu: source](#)

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY

QUICK READ

Community-based mangrove monitoring should compliment satellite data [Commentary]

Early one morning at Kudikadu, a small fishing hamlet on the Uppanar river in Cuddalore district, a forester and their team members walked the mangrove nursery before the tide turned. They carried no satellite receiver or drones; only notebooks and pencils. They counted saplings, noted which ones survived the last spring tide and which did

[Mongabay India: source](#)

HEALTH

QUICK READ

Dengue cases in Tamil Nadu decline for third consecutive year as per government data

The State recorded 17,049 cases and nine deaths in 2026 up to September 19

[The Hindu: source](#)

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS2 UPSC Editorial Analysis: Delimitation and the Difficult Balance at the Heart of India's Federalism

While rooted in the core democratic principle of equal representation—"one person, one vote, General Studies-2; Topic: Parliament and State Legislatures – structure, functioning, conduct of business, powers & privileges and issues arising out of these. Introduction Delimitation is the act of redrawing boundaries of Lok Sabha and State Assembly constituencies to reflect changes in population over time.

[Insights on India](#)

GS3 Follow the buzz? A headlong rush for data centres in India may cost the country dear

Artificial intelligence (AI) has led them to proliferate. Given their long-term effects and uncertain benefits, however, we should weigh various factors carefully before joining the global rush. Why would anyone think they're best placed in orbit?

[Mint](#)

GS2 India gains little from BRICS+

BRICS+ has become a supply chain India pays for and does not sell into

[BusinessLine](#)

GS3 Editorial. Kharif concerns

Poor rain and acreage may impact rice, water availability

[BusinessLine](#)

GS2 GS3 Microsoft AI CEO: Anthropic's AI constitution might sound advanced but deserves scrutiny

Anthropic's AI constitution bakes in enough ambiguity over the 'personhood' of AI for bots to claim rights someday—which may come to prove perilous for humanity. While the AI company's approach may be well-motivated, it needs a rethink.

[Mint](#)

GS2 GS3 India's AI opportunity is hiding beneath the index

India has lagged major markets as weaker AI exposure coincided with lower correlation to the global AI theme, highlighting the benchmark's limited participation in the technology-led rally in recent years. AI-related stocks account for only 16% of MSCI India, well below the exposure seen in Korea, Taiwan, China and Japan. Their exposure is concentrated in power equipment, utilities and technology hardware, while the group spans large, mid, small and micro-cap companies.

[BusinessLine](#)

GS3 Is there a case for raising India's inflation target? There's clearly some scope for a discussion on it

How inflation is behaving elsewhere matters when deciding the country's inflation target. Global price instability makes space for a debate over the ideal rate for monetary policymakers to pursue. But no change can be made in haste.

[Mint](#)

GS1 Persistent antagonism towards Urdu

The antagonism towards Urdu is rooted in the perception that it is exclusively a language for Muslims

[The Hindu](#)

GS2 GS3 Unsafe space: On the U.S. and 'on-orbit space control weapons'

Deployment of weapons calls for multilateral governance in space

[The Hindu](#)

GS3 Why it's time to scrap dollar billing for local SEZ deals

Rupee billing could give information technology firms another reason to stay in India's special economic zones

[BusinessLine](#)

GS2 GS3 Mint Quick Edit | India's exports to Brics trade partners have risen rapidly: retain the momentum

With world trade rattled by geopolitics, India's push to diversify its export markets has gotten a Brics boost. Can it also help achieve a better balance of imports and exports with China?

[Mint](#)

GS3 Agentic AI can be given access to digital public infrastructure only after they pass a security check

The OpenAI-Hugging Face scare over rogue agents rang a global alarm over how AI agents deployed in the real world may behave. As we start giving AI bots access to India's digital stack of Aadhaar, UPI, etc, we'll need strict protocols to keep out hostile agents.

[Mint](#)

GS1 Painted stories

Shekhawati, known as India's open-air art gallery, is home to historic merchant havelis adorned with intricate frescoes depicting everyday life, mythology and culture. Many of these architectural treasures are now deteriorating. Heritage conservationist Atul Khanna discusses efforts to restore Shekhawati's neglected havelis, the challenges of ownership and funding, and ways to preserve them through hotels, museums and community initiatives.

[Economic Times](#)

GS3 Jamie Dimon has a message for India: Don't make foreign capital work harder

India's economic momentum and financial-market reforms have not translated into foreign investment flows commensurate with its growth ambitions. Jamie Dimon's concerns about tax surprises and policy uncertainty offer an opportunity for the government to improve investor confidence, attract capital into emerging sectors such as AI infrastructure and semiconductors, and deepen India's integration with global capital markets.

[Economic Times](#)

GS2 GS3 Will Pakistan fight for Saudi Arabia?

Houthi missiles are hitting deep inside Saudi Arabia, forcing Islamabad to confront its new collective-security pledge

[BusinessLine](#)

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

Mint Explainer | What the India-New Zealand free-trade agreement means for India New Zealand has committed to eliminate customs duties on 100% of its tariff lines, covering all of India's current exports to the country.

[Mint](#)

Charges, framework, dedicated fund — How MDR on UPI works for micro and small merchants, explained From 15 October, 0.4% merchant discount rate is imposed on person-to-merchant UPI transactions over Rs. 2,000. Today, we take a look at FAQs for small and micro merchants with regards to MDR on UPI.

[Mint](#)

The science of Gaganyaan parachutes Why does Gaganyaan need multiple parachutes?

[The Hindu](#)

Is Germany's middle running out of room? Recent election results show that the political centre in Germany is feeling the squeeze from both the Right and the Left.

[Frontline](#)

What are the four pillars of academic excellence? Higher education institutions require a clear academic vision supported by four interconnected pillars: research publications, scholarly books, patents, and funded research projects...

[The Hindu](#)

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- Student gets Rs 3.5 cr grant from govt: Meet Hamirpur's Sarvesh Sharma, who built Army drone designed to evade enemy radar & resist jamming attempts (Defence) [Economic Times](#)
- GST on MDR will not impose additional burden on merchants: NPCI explains how they can adjust it against tax liability (Economy) [Mint](#)
- Rajeev Kumar's Paper 'Beyond Declarations: BRICS and the Challenge of Coordinated Global Governance Reform' Published in VIF Volume 'BRICS Role in Building a Resilient and Sustainable Global' (International Relations) [MP-IDSA](#)
- Centre keeps paddy procurement target unchanged despite lower acreage (Agriculture & Allied) [Mint](#)
- Novation of OTC Derivative Contracts (Economy) [RBI](#)

- Chinese hand grenade among arms and ammunition recovered from separate Maoist dumps in Chhattisgarh (Internal Security) [Economic Times](#)
- UK Confirms Burnham's Former Fiefdom of Manchester to Host G20 (International Relations) [Mint](#)
- Incentive scheme on the cards for critical mineral recycling: G Kishan Reddy (Governance & Policy) [Economic Times](#)
- China has what Trump needs for AI race: Why Beijing's rare earths may matter more than tariffs at Trump-Xi summit (International Relations) [Mint](#)
- Sustained dialogue key for investment, strengthening energy resilience: Puri at OPEC-India dialogue (International Relations) [The Hindu](#)
- Stem cell therapy for autism: What does the Health Ministry's latest advisory mean? (Science & Technology) [The Hindu](#)
- LCA Mark 1A induction expected in 1-2 months as engine issues resolved, testing underway: IAF Vice Chief Ashutosh Dixit (Defence) [Economic Times](#)
- NGT notices to Centre, Guj govt over NTPC's hybrid RE project near Chhari Dhand (Environment & Ecology) [The Times of India](#)
- India's Fertility Rate is now 1.9: Is Population control outdated? (Society) [Economic Times](#)

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 3 must-know, 11 Prelims facts, 14 in the news, 15 editorials, 5 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Environment & Ecology (4), Economy (2), Polity & Constitution (1), Defence (1), International Relations (1), Governance & Policy (1), Agriculture & Allied (1), Science & Technology (1), Disaster Management (1), Health (1). **Nothing today in** — Social Justice & Welfare, Education, Infrastructure & Energy, Internal Security, History, Art & Culture, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): nothing today · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 3 · Political change in the neighbourhood: nothing today · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: nothing today · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: nothing today

Full text — 0 of 34 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — The Hindu 9, Economic Times 8, Mint 7, BusinessLine 5, Mongabay India 2, RBI 1, Insights on India 1, Frontline 1

Built 04 Oct 2026, 00:10 IST by UPSC Intel. Notes quote the reports; check the source before quoting a figure in an answer.